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1. INTRODUCTION

Accessing government services in Lesotho can be challenging due to long waiting times, manual processes, overcrowding, and the repeated submission of personal information and documents. Citizens often need to visit different government departments to access related services, which can make the process time-consuming and inconvenient.

This project focuses on the design and prototyping of an integrated government services system for the Ministry of Home Affairs. The proposed system aims to provide citizens with a centralized platform for accessing Home Affairs services while allowing authorized departments such as Traffic, Finance, Pensions, Police and Passport Services to securely access relevant verified information.

The system will introduce a single citizen profile, where a citizen's information can be verified once and accessed by authorized government departments when necessary. This can reduce duplication, improve efficiency and make government services more convenient for citizens. The project applies Human-Computer Interaction (HCI) and interaction design principles throughout the process. The group will identify user requirements, develop alternative solutions, design the interface, create an interactive prototype and evaluate its usability. Accessibility and ease of use will also be considered to ensure that the system can serve different types of users.

Overall, the project aims to demonstrate how technology and user-centred design can improve the delivery of government services in Lesotho by making them more accessible, efficient and user-friendly.

2. ESTABLISHING REQUIREMENTS AND UNDERSTANDING THE PROBLEM SPACE

To establish the requirements for the proposed integrated government services system, the group analysed the six areas identified in the assignment: Home Affairs, Traffic, Finance, Pensions, Police and Passport Services. The purpose of this analysis was to understand the responsibilities of each department, identify problems that citizens may experience when accessing their services, and determine how an integrated system could address these problems.

The analysis was based on the services and responsibilities of the relevant government departments, together with the group's understanding of the problems associated with accessing these services. The Ministry of Home Affairs, for example, is responsible for establishing and maintaining identity and civil registration information, while its departments include National Identity and Civil Registration and Passport Services. The proposed system therefore focuses on connecting relevant government services through a single citizen profile, while ensuring that each department only accesses information that it is authorised to use.

2.1 Ministry of Home Affairs

Problem: Long Queues and Delays in Obtaining National Identity Documents

One of the major problems experienced by citizens in Lesotho is long queues and delays in obtaining National Identity Documents. In July 2026, the Lesotho News Agency reported that applicants at the Home Affairs office in Mafeteng experienced long queues and delays when trying to collect their identity documents. Some applicants had been

waiting since the previous day. The Acting District Manager explained that the high number of applicants was putting pressure on printing machines and causing the system to fail, resulting in slow service delivery (Lesotho News Agency, 2026).

Proposed System Solution

The proposed integrated system will introduce a digital appointment and queue-management system for Home Affairs services. Citizens will be able to select the service they require, choose an available appointment time and receive confirmation instead of spending many hours waiting physically at the office. The system can also provide notifications about the progress of an ID application and inform citizens when their document is ready for collection.

2.2 Traffic Services

Problem: Long Queues for Driving and Permit Services

Traffic services in Lesotho also experience long queues and pressure on service points. In January 2025, the Lesotho News Agency reported that people applying for D permits at the Ha Foso traffic offices in Maseru were forming queues as early as 2:00 a.m. The Ministry confirmed that the queues for D permits were long and explained that many members of the public waited until the last minute to access the service (Lesotho News Agency, 2025).

This creates inconvenience because citizens have to arrive very early and spend a significant amount of time waiting before receiving assistance. Citizens may also be required to provide personal information and identification documents when accessing Traffic Services, even though much of this information can already be verified through Home Affairs.

Proposed System Solution

The integrated system will provide a digital Traffic Services appointment and booking facility. Citizens will be able to select services such as driving licence or permit-related services, check available dates and book an appointment before visiting the Traffic office.

The system can also provide citizens with a digital queue number and estimated service time. This would reduce the number of people waiting physically at Traffic offices and make the service process more organised.

Furthermore, Traffic Services will be integrated with the Ministry of Home Affairs through the citizen's verified profile. Home Affairs will act as the source for verified citizen identity information. Once a citizen's identity has been verified, authorised Traffic officials will be able to retrieve the necessary information, such as the citizen's name, National Identity number, date of birth and photograph, instead of requiring the citizen to repeatedly provide the same information. The system will use controlled and authorised access, meaning that Traffic officials will only be able to access information relevant to the Traffic service being provided. This integration will reduce repeated paperwork, speed up the registration process and make it easier for citizens to access Traffic Services.

2.3 Finance Services

Problem: Delays in Financial and Tax-Related Services

A problem identified within government financial services is delays caused by incomplete information and difficulties in processing financial transactions. The Government of Lesotho reported that some payments to service providers were delayed because supporting information was incomplete and some suppliers were not registered in the Integrated Financial Management Information System (IFMIS). The Ministry of Finance also reported problems such as missing supporting documents and mismatches between banking details and information recorded in the system. These problems slowed the payment process (Government of Lesotho, 2023).

The Ministry of Finance provides supplier-payment services that require documents such as invoices, purchase orders, valid tax clearance certificates, trading licenses and banking details. This shows the importance of having accurate and complete information when processing financial services (Government of Lesotho, n.d.).

Proposed System Solution

The proposed system will provide a centralised Finance Services section connected to the citizen's profile. Citizens and authorised businesses will be able to submit required information electronically, check the status of financial requests and receive notifications when additional information is required.

The system can also connect verified citizen information from Home Affairs with authorised Finance Services. Once the citizen's identity has been verified by Home Affairs, authorised Finance officials will be able to retrieve the necessary identification information instead of requiring citizens to repeatedly submit the same documents. This can reduce duplication, improve the accuracy of information and support faster processing of financial services. The system will also notify users when their application or financial request has been received, requires additional information, is being processed or has been completed.

2.4 Pensions

Problem: Delays in Receiving Pension Benefits

A major problem identified within pension services in Lesotho is delays in the processing and payment of pension benefits. In June 2026, The Reporter reported that retired teachers were experiencing long delays in receiving their pensions and terminal benefits. The Office of the Ombudsman considered investigating the issue, with concerns relating to the administration and coordination of retirement-benefit processes (The Reporter, 2026).

There have also been delays in the payment of old-age pensions. In February 2026, the Ministry of Gender, Youth and Social Development reported that pension payments had been delayed because the payment system was processing transactions more slowly than expected (Lesotho News Agency, 2026). Such delays can create difficulties for pensioners who depend on these payments to meet their daily needs.

Proposed System Solution

The proposed integrated government services system will provide a Pension Services section connected to the citizen's central profile. Citizens will be able to view their pension information, submit pension-related applications and check the status of their pension or retirement-benefit requests.

The system will integrate Pensions with Home Affairs so that Home Affairs can verify the citizen's identity using their National Identity information. Once the citizen has been verified, authorised Pensions officials will be able to retrieve the necessary personal information from the citizen's profile instead of requiring the pensioner to repeatedly submit identification documents.

The system will also integrate Pensions with Finance for the processing of pension and retirement-benefit payments. Once a pension or terminal benefit has been approved by the relevant Pensions officials, the payment information can be securely forwarded to authorised Finance officials for payment processing. Finance can then update the payment status in the integrated system, the system will also provide automated notifications when a pension application has been received, when additional information is required, when the application has been approved and when payment has been processed. This will allow pensioners to monitor their applications without repeatedly visiting different government offices.

2.5 Police Services

Problem

One of the problems identified within Police Services is the difficulty of accessing reliable identity information when carrying out verification and police-related services. Police-related government services in Lesotho can require police clearance together with a certified National Identity document, demonstrating the importance of reliable identification information when accessing these services (Government of Lesotho, 2026).

The need for reliable identification is also supported by the development of digital identification services in Lesotho. The Government of Lesotho has introduced a digital identification system that uses biometric registration to support secure and reliable identification. The government has also stated that the development of an integrated national digital identity ecosystem will strengthen identity verification across government and other services (Government of Lesotho, 2026).

Proposed System Solution

The proposed integrated government services system will integrate Police Services with Home Affairs through the central citizen profile. Home Affairs will serve as the main source of verified citizen identity information. Authorised Police officials will be able to request and retrieve the identity information required for an approved police service without requiring citizens to repeatedly provide the same identification information.

The system can support biometric identity verification, such as fingerprint verification. This is consistent with the use of biometric technology in Lesotho's digital identification initiatives and with the Lesotho Mounted Police Service's use of fingerprint equipment to support investigative capabilities (Government of Lesotho, 2026; Lesotho News Agency, 2024).

Access to citizen information will be controlled according to the Police official's role and authorisation. Police officials will only be able to access information that is necessary for the specific service being provided. This will help protect citizens' personal information and prevent unauthorised access. In the proposed system, Home Affairs will provide verified citizen identity information to authorised Police Services. Once a citizen's identity has been verified, Police Services can securely request the information required for a particular service through the integrated platform.

2.6 Passport Services

Problem: Passport Backlogs and Delays

Passport services in Lesotho have experienced significant backlogs and delays in passport processing and printing. In September 2025, the Lesotho News Agency reported that the Botha-Bothe Passport Office had a backlog of 4,338 passports awaiting printing. The office was receiving more than 500 applications per day, while only about 30 passports could be processed daily. The report indicated that the backlog extended as far back as April 2024 (Lesotho News Agency, 2025).

The Ministry of Home Affairs is responsible for Passport Services and currently operates passport offices across Lesotho. The Ministry also provides an online Passport Application Status Checker, showing that digital passport-status services are already being introduced.

Proposed System Solution

The proposed integrated government services system will provide a Passport Services section with application-status tracking and notifications. Citizens will be able to submit or manage passport-related services and check the progress of their applications without repeatedly travelling to passport offices to enquire about their applications.

The system will integrate Passport Services with Home Affairs through the central citizen profile. Home Affairs will provide the verified identity information required for passport services. Since passport applications already require a National Identity document, integrating passport services with the verified Home Affairs identity record can reduce the repeated submission and verification of the same personal information.

Authorised Passport officials will be able to retrieve the necessary identity information from the citizen's verified profile. Access will be controlled so that Passport officials only receive information required for passport-related services.

Overall Problem

The problems identified across the six departments show that citizens can experience long queues, delays, repeated paperwork, fragmented information and difficulty tracking the progress of government services. These problems are not necessarily caused by one department alone; they can also result from limited processing capacity, outdated systems, communication gaps and the lack of integration between government services.

The proposed Integrated Government Services System therefore aims to create one secure citizen profile through which authorised departments can access the information they need. Instead of citizens repeatedly providing the same personal information and travelling to different offices simply to check the progress of applications, the system will allow services to be connected and information to be shared securely between authorised departments.

The system is designed to make government services more convenient, efficient and connected by allowing citizens to access multiple services through one platform while ensuring that each department only accesses the information required for its specific services.

2.8 Requirements Derived from the Problem Space

Based on the problems identified across Home Affairs, Traffic, Finance, Pensions, Police Services and Passport Services, the group established a set of functional and non-

functional requirements for the proposed Integrated Government Services System. These requirements were derived from the identified problems and are intended to address delays, long queues, repeated submission of information, fragmented services, security concerns and difficulties in tracking government applications.

2.8.1 Functional Requirements

Functional requirements describe the functions and services that the proposed system should provide.

1. Single Citizen Profile

The system should provide each citizen with one central profile containing verified basic identity information. Home Affairs will serve as the main source of verified identity information. This will reduce the need for citizens to repeatedly enter or provide the same personal information when accessing different government services.

2. Identity Verification

The system should verify a citizen's identity before allowing government services to be accessed. The verified identity information maintained through Home Affairs can be used by authorised departments to confirm a citizen's identity. This should help reduce incorrect or duplicated identity information across departments.

3. Department Integration and Profiles

The system should connect Home Affairs, Traffic, Finance, Pensions, Police Services and Passport Services through one integrated platform while allowing each department to maintain responsibility for its own services. Each department should have a separate department profile or dashboard through which authorised employees can manage the services and information relevant to their department.

Home Affairs will act as the main source of verified citizen identity information. The other departments will be connected to the Home Affairs identity system and will be able to

retrieve the specific citizen information required for their services, subject to appropriate permissions.

4. Online Access to Services

Where appropriate, citizens should be able to access available government services through the platform rather than having to manage every service separately. This can make government services more convenient and reduce unnecessary visits to government offices.

5. Document Management

The system should allow relevant documents and records to be associated with the citizen's profile. Authorised departments should be able to retrieve the required information when necessary, reducing the need for citizens to repeatedly submit the same documents.

6. Application Tracking

Citizens should be able to view the progress of applications such as passport, traffic, pension and other government services through one platform. The system should allow citizens to see whether an application has been received, is being processed, requires additional information or has been completed.

7. Queue and Appointment Management

For services that require physical attendance, the system should provide appointment and queue-management features. Citizens should be able to select an available appointment or receive a digital queue number where applicable. This can help reduce unnecessary waiting and improve the organisation of government services.

8. Notifications

The system should notify citizens about important updates, application progress, appointments and actions that they need to take. For example, a citizen could receive a notification when a passport is ready for collection, when additional information is required or when an appointment is approaching.

2.8.2 Non-Functional Requirements

Non-functional requirements describe the qualities and conditions that the system should meet while providing its functions.

1. Security and Privacy

Because the system would contain sensitive personal, financial, identity and police-related information, it should provide strong authentication, access controls and appropriate security measures. Information should only be accessed by authorised users for legitimate government-service purposes. The system should also ensure that departments only have access to information relevant to their responsibilities and permissions.

2. User-Friendly Interface

The system should have a simple and understandable interface so that citizens with different levels of digital literacy can navigate the available services easily. The interface should use clear labels, simple navigation and understandable instructions to make the platform accessible to a wide range of citizens.

3. Controlled Information Access

The system should ensure that information is protected from unauthorised access. Users should only be able to access information according to their roles and permissions. For example, an authorised Police officer may access information required to identify an individual, while a Finance official may access information required for a financial service. This will help protect citizens' personal information while still allowing departments to share the information required to provide government services.

Overall Requirement

The overall requirement is to develop an integrated government services platform based on a secure and verified citizen profile. Home Affairs will provide the central identity-

verification foundation, while Traffic, Finance, Pensions, Police and Passport Services will connect to the platform and access only the information required for their respective services.

The system should reduce duplication, improve secure information sharing, reduce unnecessary delays and queues, improve application tracking and make government services more convenient for citizens. The proposed system should therefore provide a single point of access to multiple government services while maintaining the independence, security and responsibilities of each department.

3. DEVELOPING ALTERNATIVES

After identifying the problems experienced by citizens when accessing government services, the group developed different possible solutions. These alternatives were based on the requirements identified in the problem space, including reducing long queues, avoiding repeated paperwork, improving identity verification, connecting government departments, allowing citizens to track applications and improving communication between citizens and government offices.

The alternatives were compared according to their ability to connect Home Affairs, Traffic, Finance, Pensions, Police and Passport Services. The group also considered the importance of having one secure citizen profile, separate department profiles, controlled information sharing, accessibility and ease of use. The selected alternative would be used as the foundation for developing the system design, wireframes and interactive prototype.

3.1 Alternative One: Separate Online Systems for Each Department

The first alternative is to develop a separate online system for each government department. Under this approach, Home Affairs, Traffic, Finance, Pensions, Police and Passport Services would each have their own website or application. Each department would manage its own users, information, applications and services.

For example, citizens would use one system to access Home Affairs services, another system for Traffic services and another system for Passport Services. Citizens would be required to register separately with each department and provide the information needed by that particular department.

This alternative would allow each department to develop services according to its own needs. Departments would have control over their own information and would be able to manage their applications independently. The system could also be introduced gradually, one department at a time.

However, this alternative has several limitations. Citizens would need to create different accounts for different government departments. They might also be required to submit the same personal information and supporting documents repeatedly. The departments would not be fully connected, meaning that information would remain fragmented across different systems. Identity verification would also have to be repeated when citizens access different services.

In addition, citizens would not have one central place to track all their government applications. They might need to visit different websites to check the progress of their applications or receive updates. This could continue causing confusion, delays and unnecessary visits to government offices.

Although separate departmental systems could improve access to individual services, this alternative does not fully solve the problem of fragmented government services. It also does not support the main requirement of creating one secure citizen profile connected to all six departments.

3.2 Alternative Two: Central Government Information Website

The second alternative is to develop one central government information website containing information about all six departments. The website would provide information about available services, required documents, office locations, contact details, working hours and service procedures.

Citizens would use the website to find information before visiting a government office. The website could also provide links to existing departmental websites or online services. For example, a citizen could visit the central website to find information about applying for an identity document, renewing a driving licence, accessing pension services or applying for a passport.

The main advantage of this alternative is that citizens would be able to find government service information in one place. It would reduce confusion about where to access services and what documents are required. Citizens could also view service requirements before visiting an office, which could help them prepare the necessary documents.

However, this alternative would mainly provide information rather than complete government services. Citizens might still need to visit government offices physically or use separate departmental systems to complete their applications. The website would not necessarily provide one secure citizen profile, identity verification, document sharing or application tracking.

This alternative would also not fully connect the six departments. Information about citizens would remain within the separate departmental systems, and citizens could still be required to submit the same information repeatedly. It would therefore improve access to information but would not completely solve the problems of long queues, repeated paperwork and fragmented services.

The central government information website would be useful as an information portal, but it would not meet all the requirements of the proposed integrated government services system.

3.3 Alternative Three: Integrated Government Services Platform

The third alternative is to develop an integrated government services platform connecting Home Affairs, Traffic, Finance, Pensions, Police and Passport Services. This platform would use one secure citizen profile through which citizens could access different government services.

Home Affairs would act as the main source of verified citizen identity information. Once a citizen's identity has been verified, authorised departments would be able to access only the information required for the specific service being provided. Citizens would not need to submit the same personal information repeatedly if the information is already available and authorised for use.

Each department would have its own department profile or dashboard. The department dashboard would allow authorised government employees to manage applications, verify citizen information, update application statuses, communicate with citizens and manage department-specific services.

The citizen side of the platform would include a secure login, a single citizen profile, access to the six departments, document management, application tracking, notifications and appointment or queue management. Citizens would be able to view the progress of their applications and receive updates without having to visit government offices unnecessarily.

For example, when a citizen applies for a passport, Passport Services could request verified identity information from Home Affairs. The citizen would not need to provide the same information again if it is already available and authorised for use. The citizen could also track the progress of the passport application through the platform.

Similarly, authorised Police Services could request limited identity information from Home Affairs when dealing with an emergency or an identity-verification situation. The police officer would not automatically receive access to the citizen's entire profile. Only the information necessary for the specific situation would be displayed.

The main advantages of this alternative are that it supports one secure citizen profile, connects all six government departments, reduces repeated submission of information, improves identity verification and allows citizens to track applications in one place. It can also improve communication through notifications and reduce unnecessary queues and office visits.

Each department would still be able to manage its own services through its department dashboard. This means that the system would provide integration without removing the responsibilities of individual departments.

However, this alternative would require strong security and privacy controls. It would also require coordination between the six departments, employee training, reliable internet access, technical infrastructure and financial resources. Citizens without internet access or digital skills may still need assistance through physical government offices or support centres.

Despite these limitations, the integrated government services platform meets the largest number of requirements identified in the problem space. It provides a complete solution by combining identity verification, department integration, document management, application tracking, notifications and controlled information sharing.

3.4 Alternative Four: Mobile Government Services Application

The fourth alternative is to develop a mobile government services application that citizens can use on smartphones. The application would allow citizens to create or access their profiles, view government departments, receive notifications, book appointments and track applications.

The mobile application could connect to the same central government database and allow citizens to access services from different departments. Citizens could use the application to receive updates about identity documents, driving services, pension applications, police-related services and passport applications.

The main advantage of this alternative is convenience. Citizens could access services using their smartphones without needing to visit government offices for every enquiry. Notifications could be sent directly to the citizen’s phone, and applications could be tracked from almost anywhere.

The application could also provide quick access to frequently used services. For example, a citizen could check an application status, view an appointment date or receive a notification about a missing document.

However, a mobile-only system could exclude some citizens. Not all citizens own smartphones or have reliable internet access. Some citizens may also have limited digital skills or may prefer to use computers or physical offices. Elderly citizens and people living in areas with poor network coverage may experience difficulties using the application.

Citizens would also need to download, update and maintain the application on their devices. For this reason, a mobile application should not be the only method of accessing government services. It would be more suitable as one access option within a wider integrated government services platform.

3.5 Comparison of the Alternatives

Alternative	**Main Benefit**	**Main Limitation**
Separate online systems for each department	Allows each department to manage its own services	Citizens must use different systems and repeat information
Central government information website	Provides government information in one place	Does not provide complete service integration
Integrated government services platform	Connects all six departments through one secure citizen profile	Requires strong security, coordination, training and resources
Mobile government services application	Provides convenient smartphone access	May exclude citizens without smartphones, internet or digital skills

3.6 Selected Alternative

After comparing the four alternatives, the group selected Alternative Three: Integrated Government Services Platform as the most suitable solution for the proposed project.

This alternative was selected because it addresses most of the problems identified across Home Affairs, Traffic, Finance, Pensions, Police and Passport Services. It combines several important functions into one system, including identity verification, document management, application tracking, appointment management, notifications and controlled information sharing.

The proposed system will be based on a single secure citizen profile. Home Affairs will provide the main verified identity information, while Traffic, Finance, Pensions, Police and Passport Services will have their own department profiles or dashboards. These departments will only access the information required for the specific service being provided.

The same principle will apply to the other departments. Traffic may use the verified citizen profile for driving-related services, Finance may use it for authorised financial services, Pensions may use it for pension-related applications, and Police Services may use limited identity information when authorised for a specific purpose.

3.7 Justification for Selecting the Integrated Government Services Platform

The integrated government services platform was selected for several reasons.

Firstly, it addresses several problems at the same time. The platform can help reduce long queues, repeated paperwork, delays, poor communication and difficulties in tracking applications. Citizens will be able to access information and follow the progress of their applications without making unnecessary visits to government offices.

Secondly, the platform supports one secure citizen profile. Instead of creating separate accounts for every government department, citizens will use one profile to access the services connected to the platform. This will make the process easier and reduce the repeated collection of personal information.

Thirdly, the system makes Home Affairs the foundation for identity verification. Home Affairs will maintain verified citizen identity information, which can be requested by authorised departments when necessary. This will improve the accuracy of identity verification and reduce duplication of records.

Furthermore, the platform supports separate department profiles and dashboards. Each department will have its own dashboard for managing applications, updating statuses and providing services. This allows each department to maintain its responsibilities while still being connected to the wider government system.

Moreover, the platform improves convenience for citizens. Citizens will be able to access government service information, upload documents where applicable, book appointments, receive notifications and track applications through one platform.

Again, the system supports controlled information sharing. Departments will not automatically have access to all information in a citizen's profile. Access will be controlled through authentication, role-based permissions and security measures. Each department will only receive the information necessary for its official responsibilities.

Lastly, the integrated platform is suitable for the development of an interactive prototype. The group can demonstrate the citizen profile, Home Affairs verification, department dashboards, document management, application tracking, notifications and other important functions through wireframes and prototype screens.

4. DESIGN DETAILS AND PROCESS

The design of the proposed Integrated Government Services System is based on the requirements identified from the problem space and the selected alternative. The system is designed to provide citizens with access to multiple government services through one

secure platform while allowing the six departments to maintain their own department-specific functions.

The six departments included in the system are Home Affairs, Traffic, Finance, Pensions, Police Services and Passport Services. The main design principle is that a citizen should have one secure citizen profile instead of creating separate profiles and repeatedly providing the same personal information to different government departments.

Home Affairs acts as the main source of verified citizen identity information. Other departments can connect to the verified citizen profile and retrieve only the information that they are authorised to access. Each department also has its own department profile or dashboard, allowing government employees to manage applications, verify information, update service statuses and communicate with citizens.

The design process focuses on usability, security, accessibility, integration, information sharing and efficient navigation between services.

4.1 Design Objectives

The main objective of the design is to create a system that makes government services easier, faster and more convenient for citizens while improving coordination between departments. The design aims to reduce unnecessary queues, repeated paperwork and delays caused by fragmented information.

The system is designed to achieve the following objectives:

1. Provide citizens with one secure account and citizen profile.
2. Use Home Affairs as the source of verified citizen identity information.
3. Connect Home Affairs, Traffic, Finance, Pensions, Police Services and Passport Services.
4. Provide each department with its own department profile or dashboard.

5. Allow authorised departments to retrieve only the information required for a particular service.
6. Allow citizens to upload and manage required documents digitally.
7. Allow citizens to track the progress of their applications.
8. Provide appointment and queue management where applicable.
9. Send notifications about applications, appointments and service updates.
10. Provide a simple and understandable user interface.
11. Protect citizen information through authentication, authorisation and controlled access.
12. Reduce the need for citizens to repeatedly provide the same personal information to different departments.

4.2 Overall System Structure

The proposed system follows a centralised and integrated structure. At the centre of the system is the secure citizen profile, which contains verified information associated with the citizen. Home Affairs provides the primary identity verification function.

The other government departments connect to the system through their own department dashboards. They do not automatically receive access to the complete citizen profile. Instead, the system provides information according to the department's role, the service being requested and the level of authorisation.

The basic structure of the proposed system can be represented as:

Citizen → Secure Login → Citizen Profile → Home Affairs Verification → Integrated Government Platform → Department Dashboards → Government Services

The six department dashboards are:

- Home Affairs Dashboard
- Traffic Dashboard

- Finance Dashboard
- Pensions Dashboard
- Police Services Dashboard
- Passport Services Dashboard

This structure allows the departments to remain responsible for their own services while sharing verified information through one integrated platform.

4.3 Citizen Profile Design

The citizen profile is one of the most important parts of the proposed system. Instead of requiring a citizen to create a separate account for every department, the citizen uses one secure profile to access the available government services.

The profile may contain basic verified information such as the citizen's name, identification number and other information required for authorised government services. It may also contain the citizen's submitted documents, applications, appointments, notifications and service history.

The citizen profile can be organised into different sections such as:

Personal Information: Contains verified basic citizen information.

Documents: Allows citizens to view or upload documents required for different services.

My applications: Displays applications submitted to different departments.

Appointments: Displays upcoming and previous appointments.

Application Status: Allows citizens to see whether an application is pending, being processed, approved or requires additional information.

Notifications: Provides updates from government departments.

Services: Allows citizens to select the government department and service they require.

The citizen should be able to access these functions without having to create a new profile for each department.

4.4 Home Affairs Design

Home Affairs is designed as the main identity-verification component of the system. When a citizen registers for the integrated platform, their identity can be verified against the information held by Home Affairs.

After successful verification, the citizen's verified identity information becomes part of the secure citizen profile. Other authorised departments can then request the information they require instead of asking the citizen to repeatedly provide the same identity information.

The Home Affairs department dashboard allows authorised employees to manage identity-related services, verify citizen information and process relevant applications.

The Home Affairs section may include:

- Identity verification
- Citizen information management
- National identity document services
- Application management
- Document verification
- Appointment management
- Application status updates
- Citizen notifications

4.5 Traffic Services Design

The Traffic section provides citizens with access to relevant traffic-related government services through the integrated platform.

Instead of requiring citizens to repeatedly visit a Traffic office simply to arrange a service or check progress, the system can provide functions such as appointment booking, queue management, document submission and application status tracking where applicable.

The Traffic department dashboard allows authorised employees to view and process applications, verify citizen information and update application statuses.

The Traffic section may include:

- Traffic service selection
- Appointment booking
- Queue management
- Required document information
- Application submission
- Application tracking
- Status notifications

The Traffic department can retrieve the citizen's verified identity information from Home Affairs when authorised, reducing repeated identity verification.

4.6 Finance Services Design

The Finance section is designed to provide citizens with access to relevant financial government services through the integrated platform.

Citizens can use their existing secure profile rather than creating another account for Finance. Where supporting documents or verified personal information are required, the system can allow authorised information to be retrieved or submitted digitally.

The Finance department dashboard allows authorised employees to receive applications, check submitted information, process requests and update service statuses.

The Finance section may include:

- Finance service selection
- Citizen verification
- Document submission
- Application processing
- Application tracking
- Notifications
- Status updates

This design can help reduce delays caused by incomplete information by providing citizens with clear information about the documents and requirements needed for a particular service.

4.7 Pensions Services Design

The Pensions section is designed to help citizens access pension-related services and monitor the progress of their requests.

The citizen can select the relevant pension service through their profile and submit the required information and supporting documents. The system can then provide a status-tracking function so that the citizen does not have to repeatedly visit a pension office simply to determine whether their request has been processed.

The Pensions department dashboard allows authorised employees to manage pension-related applications, verify citizen information and update application statuses.

The Pensions section may include:

- Pension service selection
- Citizen identity verification
- Document submission

- Application tracking
- Status updates
- Notifications
- Department application management

4.8 Police Services Design

The Police Services section is designed to provide authorised police officers with controlled access to citizen information when required for legitimate police activities.

Police Services should not have unrestricted access to the complete citizen profile. Instead, the system should apply role-based access so that officers can only access information necessary for the specific purpose.

For example, in an emergency where an individual is unconscious and unable to communicate, an authorised police officer could use biometric verification, such as fingerprint verification, to help confirm the person's identity. After successful verification, only authorised information could be displayed.

The Police Services dashboard may include:

- Identity verification
- Authorised citizen information retrieval
- Police service management
- Application or request management
- Emergency verification
- Status updates
- Access records

Every access to sensitive information should be controlled and recorded to improve security and accountability.

4.9 Passport Services Design

The Passport Services section is designed to allow citizens to access passport-related services through their existing citizen profile.

The system can use verified identity information from Home Affairs to reduce the need for citizens to repeatedly provide the same personal information. The system can also provide information about passport requirements, application progress and status notifications.

The Passport Services dashboard allows authorised employees to manage passport-related requests, verify citizen information and update application statuses.

The Passport section may include:

- Passport service information
- Citizen identity verification
- Document management
- Application status tracking
- Status notifications
- Department application management

The system is designed to support digital tracking and communication without assuming that the passport application itself is completed entirely online.

4.10 Department Profile and Dashboard Design

Each government department has a separate department profile or dashboard within the integrated system. This is important because the departments perform different functions and should not operate from exactly the same interface.

The department dashboard provides employees with the tools required for their specific responsibilities while maintaining a connection to the central citizen profile.

A typical department dashboard can contain:

Dashboard: Provides an overview of applications, pending requests, appointments and notifications.

Citizen Verification: Allows authorised employees to verify a citizen's identity through the integrated Home Affairs system.

Applications: Displays applications received by that department.

Documents: Allows authorised employees to review submitted documents.

Status Management: Allows employees to update the progress of an application.

Notifications: Allows departments to communicate important updates to citizens.

Access Control: Ensures employees can only access information appropriate to their role.

4.11 Information Sharing Process

The system uses controlled information sharing rather than giving every department complete access to every citizen's information.

For example, when a citizen requests a Traffic service, the Traffic department can request the necessary identity information from the verified citizen profile. The system checks whether the Traffic employee is authorised to access that information before displaying it.

The process can be represented as:

Citizen → Requests Service → Department Requests Information → System Checks Authorisation → Home Affairs Verification → Required Information Retrieved → Department Processes Service

This approach reduces duplication while protecting sensitive citizen information.

For example, Police Services may require identity information during an emergency, but this does not mean that police officers should automatically be able to view the citizen's financial or pension information.

4.12 Navigation and User Flow

The navigation design is intended to be simple so that citizens can move between government services without becoming confused.

The main citizen flow is:

Login/Register → Citizen Profile → Select Department → Select Service → Verify Information → Submit/Request Service → Receive Confirmation → Track Status → Receive Notification

For example, a citizen who wants to access a passport-related service can log into the system, open their citizen profile, select Passport Services and view the relevant service. The system can use the citizen's verified identity information from Home Affairs and display the required steps and documents. The citizen can then track the progress of the request through the same platform.

The same basic navigation structure can be applied to Traffic, Finance and Pensions, while Police Services has additional access controls because of the sensitive nature of police information.

4.13 Security and Privacy Design

Security and privacy are major design considerations because the system handles sensitive government and citizen information.

The system should require secure authentication before a citizen or government employee can access the platform. Different levels of access should be provided according to the user's role.

For example, citizens should only be able to access their own profiles, while government employees should only access information required for their department and role.

The proposed security design includes:

- Secure user authentication
- Role-based access control
- Controlled information sharing
- Identity verification
- Protection of sensitive information
- Access logging and monitoring
- Secure document management
- Automatic session management
- Limited access to sensitive police information

The principle of minimum necessary access is important. Users should only receive the information required to complete their task.

4.14 Accessibility and Usability Design

The interface is designed to be simple and understandable for citizens with different levels of digital experience. Clear labels, consistent navigation, readable text and familiar interface elements should be used throughout the system.

Important functions such as Services, My Applications, Documents, Appointments, Notifications and Profile should be easy to locate.

The design should also consider users with accessibility needs by providing sufficient text readability, clear buttons, understandable icons and consistent layouts. Important

information should not depend only on colour because some users may have difficulty distinguishing certain colours.

The system should minimise unnecessary steps and provide clear feedback after important actions. For example, after submitting a request, the system should clearly indicate that the request has been received and provide a reference or tracking number where appropriate.

4.15 Design Process

The design process follows a user-centred approach. The first stage was to identify problems experienced across the six government departments. These problems were then translated into system requirements.

The next stage was to develop alternative solutions and compare them against the identified requirements. The integrated government services platform was selected because it provides the strongest combination of integration, identity verification, information sharing, application tracking and accessibility.

After selecting the alternative, the system structure was developed. This included defining the central citizen profile, the Home Affairs identity-verification function and the separate department dashboards.

The next stage involved designing the user flow and information architecture. The main screens and functions were identified based on the services that citizens and government employees would need to access.

The design was then translated into wireframes to establish the layout and navigation before developing the higher-fidelity interactive prototype.

The design process can therefore be summarised as:

Problem Identification → Requirements → Alternative Solutions → Selection of Best Alternative → System Structure → User Flow → Wireframes → Interactive Prototype → Evaluation

4.16 Prototype Design

The prototype will demonstrate the main functions of the proposed system rather than representing a complete working government information system.

The prototype will include the major citizen-facing screens and selected department functions needed to demonstrate how the system operates. These screens will show how a citizen can log in, access the citizen profile, select government services, view applications, manage documents, track requests and receive notifications.

The prototype will also demonstrate how the six department profiles connect to the central citizen profile. The Home Affairs section will demonstrate identity verification, while the other department sections will demonstrate how authorised information can be used to provide department-specific services.

Interactive connections between screens will be included so that users can navigate through the main service flows during evaluation.

4.17 Summary of the Design

The proposed design creates an integrated government services environment where citizens use one secure citizen profile to access services from Home Affairs, Traffic, Finance, Pensions, Police Services and Passport Services.

Home Affairs provides the foundation for verified identity information, while each department has its own profile and dashboard for managing its specific services. Information is shared between departments only when the user is authorised to access it and when the information is required for a particular service.

The design therefore addresses the main problems identified in the problem space by reducing repeated information, improving identity verification, supporting application tracking, improving communication and providing more convenient access to government

services. The design details provide the foundation for the next stage of the project, which is the development of the interactive prototype.

5. EVALUATION

The proposed Integrated Government Services System will be evaluated to determine whether the prototype meets the identified user requirements and is easy for citizens and government employees to use. The evaluation will focus mainly on usability, navigation, accessibility, functionality and understanding of the integrated services.

5.1 Evaluation Method

The group will use usability testing to evaluate the prototype. Selected users will be asked to complete simple tasks using the prototype, such as logging in, viewing their citizen profile, selecting a government department, checking an application status, viewing documents and navigating between services.

The users will be observed while completing the tasks. Their difficulties, errors and comments will be recorded. After completing the tasks, users will be asked for feedback about the overall design.

5.2 Evaluation Criteria

The prototype will be evaluated according to the following criteria:

Usability: Whether users can complete tasks easily without unnecessary difficulty.

Navigation: Whether users can move between the citizen profile, departments and services without becoming confused.

Functionality: Whether the prototype interactions work as intended and allow users to follow the main service processes.

Accessibility: Whether text, buttons, icons and layouts are clear and understandable to different users.

Integration: Whether users can understand how the six departments are connected through the central citizen profile.

Security and Privacy: Whether the prototype clearly demonstrates that sensitive citizen information is controlled and only authorised departments can access the information they require.

5.3 Evaluation Tasks

Users will be given tasks that represent common activities within the proposed system. These may include:

1. Register or log into the system.
2. Open the secure citizen profile.
3. Select one of the six government departments.
4. View a government service.
5. Check the status of an application.
6. View or manage required documents.
7. Check notifications or appointments.
8. Navigate back to the main citizen profile.

The evaluation will determine whether users can complete these tasks successfully and understand the purpose of each function.

5.4 Feedback and Improvements

Feedback collected during the evaluation will be used to identify problems in the prototype. For example, if users have difficulty finding a department, the navigation may be redesigned. If users do not understand an icon or button, clearer labels may be introduced. The evaluation results will therefore be used to improve the layout, navigation, wording, accessibility and interaction design before the final prototype is presented.

5.5 Evaluation Summary

The evaluation will determine whether the proposed system is understandable, usable and capable of demonstrating the main requirements identified in the project. Usability testing will help the group identify weaknesses in the prototype and make improvements based on user feedback. This ensures that the final design is focused on the needs of citizens and government employees.

6. CONCLUSION

This project focused on designing and prototyping an Integrated Government Services System connecting Home Affairs, Traffic, Finance, Pensions, Police Services and Passport Services. The system addresses problems such as long queues, delays, repeated paperwork, fragmented information and difficulties tracking services. The proposed solution uses one secure citizen profile, with Home Affairs providing verified identity information. Each department has its own dashboard while being connected to the central system through controlled information sharing.

After considering different alternatives, the integrated platform was selected as the most suitable solution because it supports identity verification, document management, application tracking, notifications and improved access to government services. The prototype demonstrates how citizens and government departments can interact with the system in a simpler, more organised and secure way. Overall, the proposed system provides a foundation for improving the efficiency, accessibility and convenience of government services for citizens.

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